A. Today, users can explore and analyse data for Mumbai, New Delhi, Bangalore and Hyderabad. We will keep rolling out the service in additional cities around India in coming months. Some of our most important findings revolve around different observed patterns of travel times, how cities move at different times of the day, week and year.

For instance, in New Delhi, Uber Movement conducted a study mapping the impact of the festival *Dhanteras* on traffic and travel times. Data pointed to about 30 per cent increase in travel times between Ambedkar Nagar and Moolchand, and around 20 per cent hike throughout the city. A consistent pattern in inbound traffic towards the city centre was also observed.

In yet another example, by analysing Uber Movement data, we were able to examine the impact of London Bridge closure in late 2016 on travel times throughout London. Data showed about 65 per cent increase in south-bound travel times and 30 per cent increase in north-bound travel times on either side of River Thames, along with a noticeable shift throughout London.

This not only highlighted the cascading effects of the city's reliance on the bridge but also stressed on the need for alternative river crossings, and effective management of road planning and infrastructure closures.

Q. What benefits can Uber Movement platform deliver to urban traffic administratives?

A. Uber Movement was launched to help civic authorities, local governments, transportation researchers, think-tanks and policymakers in the aforementioned cities to discover ways to apply data to improve road infrastructure, and plan urban mobility and traffic strategies better.

The platform can be applied to any given set of facilities or services, be it traffic patterns in Gurugram or monsoon-led disruptions in Mumbai. The movement's data has various use cases, and has been proven to be very useful in enabling data-driven decisions about transportation challenges, such as congestion, prioritising infrastructure investment, improving safety and more.

Q. How cooperative has the government (central as well as state) been in helping with its deployment?

A. The government has been extremely welcoming and approving of Uber Movement. Together, we have been able to extract information around traffic trends and to measure the impact of extended Metro lines, first- and last-mile connectivity options, traffic interventions and more, to strengthen a data-led approach to urban planning.

We intend to engage with more policy makers, academia and civic authorities across the country to apprise them of the potential of Uber Movement in the near future.

Q. What will be your most important tip to city-level decision makers in controlling urban India's vicious traffic conditions?

A. High-quality data is the foundation of operations as public transport becomes increasingly digitised. It is crucial to find effective data-sharing solutions (what to share, how and with whom) to make the most of the gold mine the industry is sitting on.

Private companies have the technological know-how to build an application that would work towards improving the future of multi-modal transport, but combined efforts and development of a public private-partnership is imperative to utilise the best resources, create sustainably-optimised networks and transform the mobility landscape of the country.

2 OLDER PCs And LAPTOPS A Source Of HIGHER OPEX For SMEs

Main barriers to migrating to new devices are the inability of legacy applications to run on newer operating systems and the lack of budget. Benefits of adopting modern device strategies outweigh the concerns

A latest study released by Techaisle and commissioned by Microsoft and Intel depicts that small and medium-sized enterprises (SMEs) that use PCs or laptops more than four years of age may consume about ₹ 93,500 per device (US$ 1279) each time maintenance is required. The cost is sufficient to replace aging hardware with three or more new PCs. The survey was conducted across 2156 SMEs in India, Australia, Indonesia, Japan and South Korea, and showed that SMEs were directly affected by the costs due to loss of productivity and safety risks caused by outdated equipment.

The current condition

India has more than 51 million micro, small and medium enterprises (MSMEs) with a labour force of more than 114 million, accounting for more than 30 per cent of India's gross domestic product (GDP). The report revealed that despite the cost impact and security risks, 49 per cent of large SMEs and 31 per cent of small SMEs continue to use old PCs. The new research shows that, as of last year, up to 43 per cent SMEs experienced PC security and data theft vulnerabilities, and only 12 per cent of them reported these attacks.

On the other hand, SMEs that have adopted modern workplace strategies have experienced higher productivity, reduced costs and increased security.

The study also revealed that 66 per cent of SMEs improved efficiency by